

8.3 Achieving sustainable development

1 Are the following statements true or false?

- a** The goals of the UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) include ending poverty, addressing inequality and combating climate change.
- b** Aid guarantees positive outcomes for low-income countries.
- c** Trade contributes to development by driving economic growth and reducing poverty.

Making connections across different topics in geography is sometimes known as synoptic thinking. It involves recognising links between themes, identifying patterns and understanding how one concept can influence another. Here are some examples of connections between this topic and [Topic 7, 'Changing towns and cities'](#):

- Economic development can relate to environmental sustainability. Wealthier societies tend to use more resources, such as cars, personal technology or air conditioning, which generate pollution and drive climate change. Conversely, poorer societies tend to lack basic services, such as sewage systems and clean water. Both of these examples may lead to environmental damage.
- Changes in life expectancy can affect urban planning. Cities with more youthful populations require more amenities such as

schools, whereas those with ageing populations may require more healthcare and supported living.

2 Evaluate the impact of rural-urban migration on the development of both rural and urban areas. [7]

3 To what extent does rapid economic development lead to environmental degradation? [7]

REFLECTION

Making connections will help you to see the bigger picture in geography, which can improve your overall understanding of the course. Making connections also enables you to form well-rounded answers when you answer questions. All topics within geography link to others. Try to think about what other synoptic links exist in this course.

Using a large piece of paper with the topics written on and drawing and labelling arrows between the topics is a good way to see the links. Do you think that this approach would help you to see the wider picture?

« RECALL AND CONNECT 3 »

Sustainable development can only be achieved if a country successfully manages its population. Too many people leads to overpopulation and too few people leads to underpopulation. Both scenarios can hinder development. See if you can answer the following questions linked to [Topic 6, 'Population change'](#).

a What is fertility rate?

b What is natural increase?

4 Sort the following strategies into 'Top-down' or 'Bottom-up' development strategies:

- microfinance
- debt relief
- NGO-led projects
- UN Sustainable Development Goals

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5 Fill in the blanks, using three terms from below:

**bilateral microfinance debt top-down
NGO**

_____ relief is where organisations or governments cut or cancel a country's debt. This allows the country to invest in essential areas like healthcare and education.

_____ aid involves direct assistance from a donor country to a recipient country, often with agreements attached, such as the Akosombo dam project in Ghana.

_____ development strategies involve decision-making by governments or large organisations, often for large-scale projects, like building a hydroelectric dam.

UNDERSTAND THESE TERMS

- Standard of living
- Top-down development strategies
- Bottom-up development strategies
- Aid

SELF-ASSESSMENT CHECKLIST

Let's revisit the knowledge focus and exam skills focus for this topic.

Decide how confident you are with each statement.

Now I can	Show it	Needs more work	Almost there	Confident to move on
Explain how to define and measure development	How are countries measured and classified according to their level of development?			
Give social, economic and environmental reasons for uneven development	Name one social, one economic and one environmental reason for uneven development.			
Evaluate top-down and bottom-up strategies used to reduce uneven development	What are the advantages and disadvantages of top-down and bottom-up			

Now I can	Show it	Needs more work	Almost there	Confident to move on
	development strategies?			
Understand the command word 'plot'	Answer a 'plot' question confidently, such as those in Section 8.1 of this topic.			
Understand the assessment phrase 'to what extent'	Answer a 'to what extent' question confidently, such as 'To what extent does being landlocked limit a country's economic development?'			
Make connections between different topics	Make a list of synoptic links that can be found within this course.			